

Week 1 Starter Path

Five carefully sequenced AMI Montessori activities — one per day. For families with children ages 3–6.

How to use this guide

Choose a quiet 10–20 minute window each morning. Prepare the materials before inviting your child. Sit beside them, move slowly, and let the child lead. Repetition is welcome — many children will return to an activity for days.

Day 1 • Practical Life

Pouring Water

Pouring is the first practical life activity in the AMI sequence. It builds focus, coordination, and confidence to work independently.

What you'll need

- A small tray
- Two identical small pitchers
- A sponge cloth for spills
- A few ounces of water in the left pitcher

The presentation

1. Sit beside the child at a small table.
2. Slowly grasp the handle of the left pitcher with your dominant hand.
3. Lift, pour into the right pitcher in one smooth motion, watching the spout.
4. Set the pitcher down. Pause. Switch pitchers and repeat in the opposite direction.
5. Invite: 'Would you like a turn?' Then step back and let the child work.

Observe. Notice what draws the child's attention. Repetition is the child's work — let them return tomorrow.

Day 2 • Practical Life

Spooning & Sorting

Refines hand control — the muscular foundation for writing later on. Builds the pincer grip and crossing the midline.

What you'll need

- A tray with two small bowls
- A small spoon
- Two cups of dry beans, lentils, or beads (one bowl filled)

The presentation

1. Place the full bowl on the left, the empty bowl on the right, spoon between them.
2. Show: grip the spoon with thumb and first two fingers.
3. Slowly transfer one spoonful at a time, left to right.
4. When the left bowl is empty, switch positions and reverse the work.

Observe. Notice what draws the child's attention. Repetition is the child's work — let them return tomorrow.

Day 3 • Sensorial

The Pink Tower

Trains the eye to discriminate dimension — a key visual sense and a foundation for the decimal system in math.

What you'll need

- A set of 10 graded pink cubes (or 5 stacking blocks for a starter version)
- A floor mat or rug

The presentation

1. Unroll the mat. Carry each cube one at a time, both hands, from shelf to mat.
2. Place all cubes randomly on the mat.
3. Build the tower from largest to smallest, centering each cube.
4. Trace the smooth edge with two fingers — top to bottom.
5. Disassemble in reverse and return each cube to the shelf.

Observe. Notice what draws the child's attention. Repetition is the child's work — let them return tomorrow.

Day 4 • Language

Sandpaper Letters

Connects the letter sound with the muscular memory of writing. Introduce sounds (not letter names) at first.

What you'll need

- 3 sandpaper letters with contrasting backgrounds (start with s, m, a)
- A felt or smooth tray

The presentation

1. Present one letter. Trace it with two fingers in writing direction. Say its sound: 'sss'.
2. Invite the child to trace. Repeat the sound together.
3. Three-period lesson: 'This is sss.' → 'Show me sss.' → 'What is this?'
4. Add a second letter only when the first is secure.

Observe. Notice what draws the child's attention. Repetition is the child's work — let them return tomorrow.

Day 5 • Mathematics

Number Rods

Makes quantity concrete before it becomes a symbol. The child holds, sees, and counts real lengths.

What you'll need

- 10 number rods (or 10 craft sticks cut to graded lengths)
- A floor mat

The presentation

1. Lay the rods randomly on the mat.
2. Build the staircase: align all left ends, longest at the bottom.
3. Count each segment: '1', then '1, 2', then '1, 2, 3'...
4. Invite the child to count. Pause and let them correct themselves.

Observe. Notice what draws the child's attention. Repetition is the child's work — let them return tomorrow.

After Week 1

Open the Montessori Life Skills app to continue with the full AMI sequence — eight curriculum areas, hundreds of precise activities, with photorealistic materials and child-paced lessons.

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